Vernon E.S.

Changes beginning in 2027-28

WHAT'S HAPPENING?

- Vernon would change from a K-8 school to a neighborhood K-5 school.
- Middle grade (6th-8th) students would move to Harriet Tubman Middle School.

WHY IS PPS CONSIDERING THIS?

- Comprehensive middle school access: Changing Vernon from a K-8 to a K-5 model provides middle grade students access to Harriet Tubman Middle School, helping keep student numbers steady at Tubman.
- Seismically upgraded building: Vernon received a full seismic retrofit in Summer 2026, offering strong building conditions for elementary learning.

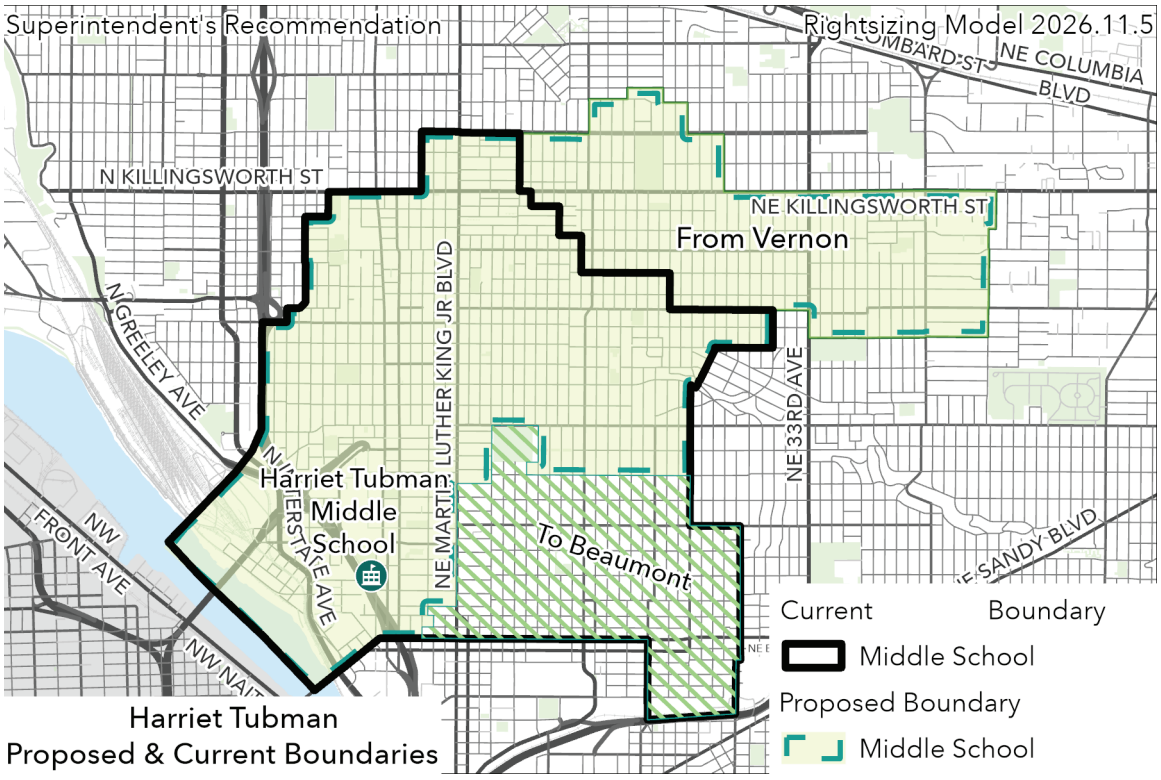
WHAT ELSE WAS CONSIDERED?

- Middle grade enrollment support: Moving middle grades to Harriet Tubman supports balanced middle grades enrollment across the cluster.

WHAT WOULD STUDENTS GAIN?

- Elementary-focused school: Allows elementary students to benefit from a school designed entirely for early childhood development.
- Full middle school experience: Middle school students gain access to the broader electives, athletics, and learning options of a comprehensive middle school.

WHERE WOULD THE SCHOOL BOUNDARY BE?



SCHOOL BUILDING CAPACITY & ENROLLMENT

	Functional Capacity	Utilization %	Historical Peak Enrollment	Current Enrollment (2026-2027)
Receiving site	552	89.1%	607 (2019-20)	492

Projected enrollment

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Status Quo/No Change	492	488	477	463	453
Recommendation	325	323	321	316	321

ENROLLMENT AND TRANSFER

- Neighborhood students: 5th-7th grade students residing in the Vernon attendance area will enroll at Harriet Tubman M.S.
- PPS transfer students: 5th-7th grade students who attend Vernon but do not reside in the attendance area will enroll at Harriet Tubman M.S. or may transfer to their neighborhood school by home address

WHO WOULD THE SCHOOL SERVE?

Option	Poverty	Special education	Multilingual services	Underserved racial groups	Title I
Status Quo/No Change	27.9%	11.8%	4.6%	27.2%	Not Title 1
Recommendation	26.2%	13.8%	5.6%	25.4%	Not Title 1

ACADEMIC PROGRAM TRANSITIONS

- Academic Programs: Vernon will only serve students in grades K-5. Based on current enrollment projections, there will be two classrooms at each grade-level, with blends not required. Students will receive PE, Arts, and Library/Media instruction each week. Based on enrollment, the school will be supported by a part-time counselor.
- Special Education: Currently, Vernon has two Learning Center classes. With rightsizing, Vernon will receive one SES classroom that currently serves students at Sabin. Vernon will have two Learning Centers and one SES classroom.
- Student and Family Supports: Happy Valley Counseling is identified as Vernon's school-based mental health partner. Student Services is reviewing continuity of services for middle-grade students who may transition to Harriet Tubman. Depending on country and district budgets, the existing SUN program and other culturally-specific partnerships will remain intact.

School transition supports: Teams from Central Office have developed a framework for implementing Rightsizing. This includes a menu of transition supports for all impacted school communities. This work is informed by lessons learned by districts across the country that have had successful school consolidations. The implementation framework includes guidance on merging academic programs and school-based teams, (such as Instructional Leadership, Climate, PTAs and others) tools, resources, and timelines. The framework includes timelines for merging school communities and onboarding staff, families and students to their new campuses. It also includes staffing timelines and plans for packing and moving furniture and instructional resources. This comprehensive framework will be shared with the community in December. If the Board of Education votes to proceed with Rightsizing for fall 2027, Central Office teams will begin working with school communities in January to implement transition supports appropriate to each community.